



PHOTO BY MANDAR DEODHAR

itself is not expanding as much.

That said, it's a good time to be around because the Indian economy is growing, along with consumption. But innovation is critical. It's not a ready-to-harvest advertising market, with one having to shape and create the market. You will need to expand the pool of advertisers, innovate, and disrupt advertising formats.



For general entertainment channels, there is a view that appointment viewing is on the way out. What's your take? People make appointments because they find it worth their while. If content is compelling, people will make an ap-

New-age media firms have innovated well on distribution and consumer experience, but not on monetisation

pointment for a big movie. You will go to the theatre on Friday for a movie that excites you. A big cricket match has the whole nation showing up, regardless of what the screen is. I think the growth in distribution and consumption hasn't kept pace. Also, the growth in creative innovation has not kept pace with growth in distribution and consumption.

So, there is an element of fatigue and that is the opportunity to disrupt.

In 2008-09, when I was running Star as CEO, we had the same situation. The market was slowing down without enough excitement. Entertainment consumption was shrinking and then came Colors and challenged Star. It dislodged Star for a few

months from its No 1 position. Interestingly, the market expanded and from the number of new viewers to the time spent to revenues, everything was up. We are not doing enough to stoke viewing.



Your combined size in the digital space is as massive as it is on linear television. Is there a playoff between the two when it comes to advertising?

If we didn't have linear TV or digital, it would be a very different strategy. Since we have great scale and reach in both segments, why would we de-emphasize one or the other? We see this is a complementary service and viewers don't make that distinction—if there's an IPL game, people want to watch it on the best available screen. I think there is an opportunity to offer integrated and tailored solutions. To give you an example—in the very first year that we got the IPL rights for JioCinema, we did some serious innovation. We introduced multi-camera for instance, which for television is not the best destination, but for a relaxed experience, is good. Star had the television rights but the consumption on both grew significantly. You need to offer a better